

Finally, a Requirement Specification document or a Software Requirement Specification (SRS) is created which serves as a guideline for the next phase. The testing team follows the Software Testing Life Cycle and starts the Test Planning phase after the requirements analysis is completed.

Design

The main architecture of the system is designed during this phase. The primary objective is to convert the business requirements laid out in the previous phase into a robust and feasible system architecture.

The hardware and software requirements are specified in this phase and the overall product architecture is finalised. These design specifications serve as the input for the next phase of the software development life cycle.

The software/technical architects use the Software Requirements Specification or SRS as a reference to create the best and the most suitable architecture for the product. Usually, multiple approaches or solutions are proposed and thoroughly scrutinized before making a decision. These approaches are documented into what is called the Design Document Specification or DDS.

A design approach defines all the architectural modules of the product along with its data flow representation with the external and third party modules (if required). The internal design of all the modules of the proposed architecture should be clearly defined with the tiniest of the details in DDS.



The architectural design determines how the software will achieve its goal